



Backbone: Gukesh accompanied by his father and Grzegorz Gajewski (left). FIDE

Viswanathan Anand, who suggested bringing Gajewski on board as the primary trainer — a move that proved pivotal.

Gajewski led the charge, coordinating the team's efforts and ensuring Gukesh was battle-ready for every match. He enlisted his countryman Jan-Krzysztof Duda, a former World Cup winner known for his creative play, whose training games helped Gukesh stay sharp during the gruelling year.

Gukesh played over 300 online blitz games against Duda throughout the Candidates and World championship.

Radosław Wojtaszek, another Pole and trusted veteran from Anand's team, brought years of expertise to the table. Meanwhile, Pentala Harikrishna, who had previously played a key role in Ju Wenjun's 2023 World championship victory, added a unique edge. Harikrishna's insights into the Chinese mindset and strategies became invaluable as Gukesh prepared to face Ding.

In Germany's Vincent Keymer, Gukesh found not only a formidable partner but also a friend to explore bold new ideas. A regular in the world's top 20, Keymer brought a fresh perspective to Gukesh's

Team Gukesh

Seconds

Grzegorz Gajewski (Poland)
Jan-Krzysztof Duda (Poland)
Radosław Wojtaszek (Poland)
Pentala Harikrishna (India)
Vincent Keymer (Germany)
Jan Klimkowski (Poland)

Mental Conditioning Coach

Paddy Upton

Mentor

Viswanathan Anand